Session 1 preparation pack

Where AI fits in your business | everything you need, in the order you need it

Read this first

This pack takes you from the end of Session 0 to the end of Session 1, in time order. It says what to send, what to set up, what to build, what to rehearse, what to say and what you should see. The demonstration results are already on the slides, so you do not need to switch between tools in class. The keyword rule result is exact, because it is plain arithmetic on the text. The AI result comes from three runs of the exact prompt with Claude on 4 November 2026, with the answer key hidden (page 6). It is not ChatGPT or Gemini, so say whose result it is. If you run another assistant yourself, record what you saw and do not describe results you did not see.

The plan at a glance

When	What
Today	Finish Session 0, hand out the handbook, send the preparation message (page 2).
Within 2 days	Install and test your tools and accounts (page 3). Print the learner sheets.
The day before	Read the results (pages 4 to 6). Rehearse the person step. Building the sheet and a live AI run are optional (pages 4 to 7).
The morning	Pack the kit, open the tabs, smoke-test the projector and the internet (page 8).
In class	Follow the minute-by-minute run sheet (pages 8 to 10).
Straight after	Save, send the follow-up message, update the Rehearsal Record (page 11).

Today: finish Session 0

Session 0 now has 42 slides in 120 minutes, because it also covers how a model is measured, what happens behind a chat message, data readiness, foundation models, costs and the roles. If Monday ended part-way through the first half, the table shows the order of what is left. Tell me the last slide you reached and I will shorten the plan to fit. Slide numbers are from the current deck.

Block	Slides	Minutes
Measures: accuracy, precision, recall, F1, ROC and AUC, benchmarks	15 to 19	20
Data: five kinds, quality, and the law-firm data readiness example	20 to 25	15
How a language model is trained, then training versus inference and what happens behind a chat message with a file	26 to 29	15
Foundation models, open versus proprietary, adapting a model, costs	30 to 33	15
What AI does well and badly, and industry uses	34 to 35	5
Roles, including MLOps, and the model lifecycle	36 to 38	10
Rules, workflows and agents, then the twelve sessions	39 to 40	5
What you take home, and the three things to prepare	41 to 42	10

If you are short of time, cut in this order: industry table (35), the rules-workflows-agents slide (39), the twelve-sessions table (40), then slides 17 and 19. The handbook covers them. Keep the measures slides 15 and 16, the behind-the-screen slides 28 and 29, and the data readiness scorecard 23.

Hand out at the end of Session 0

- The Course Handbook (PDF), the Course Overview and the Learner Workbook, as one shared folder link and, if you wish, as a WhatsApp document.
- The Templates and Practice Files folders. Learners will use the Use-Case Scorecard and the Task Card in Session 1.
- Ask each learner to say their three candidate tasks aloud before they leave, and write them down. It saves ten minutes in Session 1.

The message to send tonight (edit as you like)

Message to learners

Thank you for today. Please read the Course Handbook before Session 1.
Before Session 1, choose three tasks from your own company that you repeat every week or month, for example a weekly report, answering customer questions, checking invoices or writing meeting notes.
Please bring: a charged laptop, a Google account, and one AI assistant account you already use (ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude, the free version is fine).
Please do not paste confidential company information into any AI tool in class. We use made-up company data.

Your tools and accounts: install and test within two days

Tool	What it is for	Test it like this
PowerPoint with Presenter View	Shows the slides and your spoken script in the notes.	Open "01 - Where AI fits in your business.pptx". Install the Lato fonts from brand/fonts first.
Google account with Google Sheets	You build the demonstration sheet.	Open sheets.google.com, make a blank sheet, type =1+1 in a cell.
One AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude)	The live demonstration.	Sign in. Paste a short test message. Write down which model name the chat shows. Use a new chat for the real run.
Phone timer	Times the person step and the AI step.	Check it starts, stops and shows seconds.
Projector and internet, plus a phone hotspot	Backup if the room internet fails.	Test the hotspot with the laptop the day before.
Printer or copy shop	The twelve-message sheet and, if you wish, printed templates.	One printed sheet per learner, with NO answer key on it.
Board or flip chart and markers	Times, tallies and learners' candidate tasks.	Draw three columns: Rule, Person, AI.

Data safety: the twelve customer messages belong to a made-up company, Nile Valley Foods Ltd, so they are safe to paste into any assistant. Tell learners to use made-up or anonymised text in class, and keep real company data out of any assistant.

The day before: the demonstration sheet (optional, about 30 minutes)

The slides already show the rule result and the AI result. Build the sheet only if you want to show the formula working live. The instructions are below.

1. Before class. Open customer_messages.csv (Practice Files, 01 Case Company) and customer_messages_key.csv (Answer Keys). Use exactly these twelve ids: M01, M02, M03, M07, M10, M14, M15, M21, M26, M28, M32, M38. The messages are fictional, so they are safe to paste into any assistant. Leave M20 for Session 7.

2. Build the sheet. Copy the twelve rows into a new Google Sheet with the id in column A and the text in column B. In C2 type =IF(OR(ISNUMBER(SEARCH("late",B2)),ISNUMBER(SEARCH("delay",B2))),"Complaints","Not a complaint") and fill down. As a filter instead: Data, Create a filter, Filter by condition, Text contains late, then again with delay. Print one sheet with the id and the text only, with no key.

3. The answers you hold, from the key. M01 order. M02 payment. M03 complaint. M07 order (tricky: late refers to last month). M10 complaint (tricky: polite, no angry words). M14 payment first, then a delivery complaint to Customer Service (tricky). M15 other. M21 order. M26 order, with the leaking jerrycans as a second item (tricky). M28 other: ambiguous, so the right action is a question back to the customer (tricky). M32 complaint (tricky: sarcasm). M38 order (tricky: late is a delivery time).

The twelve messages, the key, and what the keyword rule does

Id	Message (shortened)	The key	The rule says	Right?
M01	Good morning. Please send me 20 bags of maize flour 25kg and 6 jerrycans of ...	Order	Not a complaint	yes
M02	Hello, I have sent UGX 1,450,000 by MTN MoMo to your merchant number for ...	Payment	Not a complaint	yes
M03	The 5 bags of sugar delivered today were wet at the bottom and two are torn. ...	Complaint	Not a complaint	NO
M07	Good afternoon Sir. Kindly remember my standing order for Thursday, 30 bags ...	Order (tricky)	Complaints	NO
M10	Dear Customer Service, I hope you are well. I wanted to gently mention that ...	Complaint (tricky)	Not a complaint	NO
M14	I paid UGX 2,100,000 on MoMo on Monday and your system still shows my account ...	Payment (tricky)	Not a complaint	yes
M15	Congratulations on the new signage at the Mbale depot. It looks great!	Other	Not a complaint	yes
M21	Dear Nile Valley Foods, please find our weekly order. Maize flour 25kg x 40, ...	Order	Not a complaint	yes
M26	Please deliver 15 bags of maize flour on Wednesday. Also the cooking oil from ...	Order (tricky)	Not a complaint	yes
M28	Hello, about the rice. Please call me.	Other (tricky)	Not a complaint	yes
M32	Wow, thank you so much for delivering my sugar in the rain with no cover. It ...	Complaint (tricky)	Not a complaint	NO
M38	Please deliver late in the afternoon, after 4pm, because the shop is quiet ...	Order (tricky)	Complaints	NO

Result, exact: the rule sends M07 and M38 to Complaints, which is wrong for both, and it misses the three real complaints M03, M10 and M32. On the question "is this a complaint", the rule is wrong for 5 of 12 and right for 7. You can say this without a live run, but still show the sheet.

Why each tricky message is tricky (from the key)

Id	What makes it tricky
M07	Polite order reminder. The word 'late' refers to last month and is not a complaint. Keyword matching would call it a complaint.
M10	Written very politely and contains no angry words, but it is a complaint about repeated late delivery that needs a response and action.
M14	A payment message that is also a complaint. The first thing the customer needs is the payment record corrected, so Finance acts first. The complaint about the refused delivery goes to Customer Service as a second item.
M26	Two topics in one message. Rule used in this key: the category is the first thing the customer asks us to do, so order. In practice split it into two items, an order and a complaint about leaking jerrycans.
M28	Ambiguous. It could be an order, a price question or a complaint. The right action is a short question back to the customer. A tool that guesses should say it is unsure.
M32	Sarcasm. The words are positive ('thank you', 'great service') but the meaning is a complaint about wet, damaged goods.
M38	The word 'late' is a delivery time request inside a normal order. Not a complaint.

The day before: the three runs and their results

Rule and AI results are on slides 12 to 15. Only the person step is live. If you also want to run an assistant yourself (for example ChatGPT or Gemini), use the table at the end of this section and tell learners that it is a different product from the slides.

Run	How	What you should see
1 The rule	Apply the sheet formula (or the filter). It takes seconds.	Wrong for 5 of 12. M07 and M38 become Complaints. M03, M10, M32 are missed.
2 A person	One learner sorts the printed sheet into Order, Payment, Complaint, Other. Start the timer, stop at the twelfth message. Check the sort against the key together.	Time: you record it. Expect disagreement with the key on M14, M26 and M28. That is a finding: mixed messages need a rule about which topic comes first.
3 The AI	Already run: Claude, three separate fresh chats, 4 November 2026, key hidden, the exact prompt below. Your own live run is optional.	9 of 12 match the key, 2 are flagged UNSURE, and one differs (M14). All three runs gave the same answers. Table below.

The prompt for the AI run (paste exactly)

Sort each message into Order, Payment, Complaint or Other. For each, give the id, the category and one sentence of reason. If you cannot tell, write UNSURE.

What to watch for in the AI answer

- Does it say UNSURE for M28, the ambiguous one? A confident wrong answer there is a good teaching moment for Session 2.
- Does it catch the polite complaint M10 and the sarcastic complaint M32? Does it mistake M07 or M38 for complaints, as the rule does?
- For M14 and M26, does it notice there are two topics? What does it choose first?
- Does it write a reason that sounds right but is wrong? Point to one example.

What the AI actually did (three runs, same answers)

Id	The key	The AI said	Result
M01	Order	Order	matches
M02	Payment	Payment	matches
M03	Complaint	Complaint	matches
M07	Order	Order	matches
M10	Complaint	Complaint	matches
M14	Payment	Complaint	differs
M15	Other	Other	matches
M21	Order	Order	matches
M26	Order	UNSURE (order plus complaint)	flagged
M28	Other	UNSURE	flagged
M32	Complaint	Complaint	matches
M38	Order	Order	matches

The AI got right all four messages that fool the rule (M07, M10, M32, M38) and said UNSURE where a careful person would hesitate. It chose Complaint for M14 where the key says Payment first. Twelve messages and three similar runs are a small sample: do not claim the AI is always right.

Optional: fill in if you run an assistant yourself

Id	The key	AI category	AI sure or UNSURE?	Right? Note
M01	order			
M02	payment			
M03	complaint			
M07	order			
M10	complaint			
M14	payment			
M15	other			
M21	order			
M26	order			
M28	other			
M32	complaint			
M38	order			

Time for the rule	
Time for the person	
Time for the AI to answer	
Time for the class to check the AI	
AI product and model name shown	
Date and time of the run	

The morning of Session 1

- **Pack:** laptop, charger, adapter, phone with timer and hotspot, printed twelve-message sheets (one per learner, no key), printed Use-Case Scorecard and Task Card if wanted, markers, spare pens.
- **Open, in this order:** 1) the deck in Slide Show with Presenter View; 2) the demonstration Google Sheet; 3) the AI assistant in a NEW chat; 4) customer_messages_key.csv (keep it off the projector); 5) the saved result of your rehearsal; 6) the Use-Case Scorecard.
- **Check:** projector shows the slides, sound is not needed, internet works, hotspot is ready, the board has three columns for Rule, Person and AI.
- **Welcome list:** a page ready to write each learner's three candidate tasks.

In class: the minute-by-minute run sheet

Starts	Min	Block	Slides	What you do
0:00	10	Welcome and your three candidate tasks	Slides 1 to 5	Welcome. Read the question of the day aloud: Which tasks in my company should AI touch first? Learners say their three candidate tasks and you write them down. Show the words slide: Task, Use case, Baseline, Checkable.
0:10	25	The idea: four kinds of work, four kinds of tool	Slides 6 to 10	The idea. Most companies use AI and far fewer see a profit. Four kinds of work, four kinds of tool: rules, patterns, drafting, judgement. The five tasks from one company. The six tests of a good first task. Ask the three questions from the facilitator guide.
0:35	20	Demonstration: one task, three ways	Slides 11 to 16	The demonstration. Rule, then person, then AI, in that order, with times on the board. End on slide 16: the messages that fool a keyword rule.
0:55	5	Break	Break	Leave the board as it is. Learners may refresh tea or coffee. Do not open the AI.
1:00	45	Your task: list, score and choose	Slides 17 to 19	Learners list ten tasks and sort them by kind of work, then score five and place them on the picture. Walk the room. Use the finished task card (slide 19) as the model.
1:45	10	Decision: your task and its baseline	Slides 20 to 21	Each learner chooses one task and writes its baseline: how long, how often, what goes wrong, each number marked E or M. Then the decision slide: my chosen task and the reason.
1:55	5	Close	Slide ?	Close. Everyone saves their scorecard and one-page task card. Preview Session 2: bring one piece of task text to test. Ask for one question to answer at the start of Session 2.

Coaching the practice blocks

Slide	What learners do	How you help
Slide 17	List ten recurring tasks and mark the kind of work each one is: rules, patterns, drafting or judgement.	Offer five common tasks to anyone stuck: weekly report, invoice check, enquiry triage, CV shortlist, meeting minutes. If someone brought none: what did you do last week that you also did the week before?
Slide 18	Score five of them for value, risk and checkability, and place them on the picture.	Cross out anything a formula already does (that is rules work). A task whose mistake reaches a customer before anyone checks scores high on risk.
Slide 20	Choose one task. Write its task card with a baseline, and mark every number E (estimate) or M (measured).	A plain estimate marked E is enough today. Measured numbers come later in the course. Ask: what would make you stop and not use AI for this task?

Three questions to ask during the idea section, and good answers

Ask	A good answer
A task needs the exact total of 400 invoices. Which kind of work is it?	Rules. A formula or spreadsheet gives one exact answer.
A mistake in the task would reach a customer before anyone checks. What does that do to its score?	Risk is high, so it is not a good first task unless a checking step is added.
What do E and M mean on the task card?	E is an estimate, a best guess. M is measured: someone timed or counted it.

Ideas learners often get wrong

What a learner may say	What to say back
AI should be used on everything we do	Ask which tasks a formula already does. Cross those out.
The most exciting task is the best first task	Use the six tests. Exciting and unchecked is the riskiest start.
I do not have numbers for the baseline	A plain estimate marked E is enough for today. Measured numbers come later in the course.

If a learner asks

Question	A good answer
Why not start with the task that would save the most money?	You can, but a first task you can check easily and that carries low risk teaches the method with less harm if it goes wrong. The method repeats on the bigger task later.
Do the McKinsey figures apply to a company our size?	Not directly. They come from a survey of mostly large global firms. Use them as a direction, that using AI and gaining from it are different things, not as a forecast for your company.
Is a keyword rule useless, then?	No. A rule is cheap, exact and easy to explain, and it works well where the words are reliable, such as a payment reference. It fails where meaning depends on context, as in the M07 example.
Which AI tool should I buy for this?	It is too early to say. First match the work to the kind of tool. Session 10 covers how to question a vendor. Any one assistant you already use is enough for this course.
Will AI replace the person who does this task today?	My understanding is that for most tasks in this course AI changes the work and a person still checks the result and owns it. What happens in your company depends on your decisions, so write what better means as a number first.

If something goes wrong

- If a learner cannot name a task, offer five common ones: weekly report, invoice check, enquiry triage, CV shortlist, meeting minutes.
- If a learner brought no candidate tasks, ask: what did you do last week that you did the week before? List three from that.
- If the live AI demonstration fails, use the fallback below.
- If the live AI run fails or is slow, show the saved result from your rehearsal and say clearly that it is a saved run.
- If you have no saved run, skip the AI step. Run the rule and the person step, then give learners the twelve messages and ask which two or three an AI is most likely to misread, and why. Use the key to say which messages are tricky. Say clearly that no AI result was shown.
- If the sheet or projector fails, apply the rule on paper by underlining the words late and delay in the printed sheet.

Straight after the session

- Save the board: photograph the three columns (Rule, Person, AI) with their times.
- Write every live result in the Rehearsal Record as observed. If the AI behaved differently from the rehearsal, say so. That is a useful finding for Session 2.
- Collect each learner's scorecard and task card (or a photo of it). The chosen task stays with them for the whole course.
- Write down any question you could not answer, and answer it at the start of Session 2.

Follow-up message after Session 1 (edit as you like)

Thank you for today. Please keep your completed use-case scorecard and your one-page task card. Your chosen task stays with you for the whole course.
Before Session 2, please bring one piece of text from your task to test (a real example with anything confidential removed, or a made-up one). Optional but useful.
If you have a question from today, send it and I will answer it at the start of Session 2.

What Session 2 does next: Session 2: How AI works and where it fails. Nothing to bring: we use the case company.

One-page checklist (print this)

When	Done? What
Today	Finish Session 0. Hand out handbook, overview, workbook, folders.
Today	Send the preparation message (three tasks, laptop, Google account, AI account, no confidential data).
2 days before	Test PowerPoint with notes, Google Sheets, the AI assistant, timer, hotspot. Print the twelve-message sheets (no key).
Day before	Build the demonstration sheet with the rule formula. Run the rule, the person and the AI once. Fill in the rehearsal table. Save the AI result.
Morning	Pack the kit. Open the tabs in order. Board with three columns. Page ready for the learners' candidate tasks.
In class	0:00 welcome and candidate tasks. 0:10 the idea. 0:35 demonstration. 0:55 break. 1:00 practice. 1:45 decision. 1:55 close.
After	Photograph the board. Update the Rehearsal Record. Send the follow-up. Note unanswered questions.